INCIDENT LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION IN SERVICENOW

Solution Requirements

Functional & Non-Functional Requirements

Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Document Name	Solution Requirements (Functional & Non-Functional)
Phase	2. Requirement Analysis
Date	08 September 2026
Team ID	
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

1. Purpose

Requirement analysis defines what the Incident Lifecycle Automation solution must do, and how well it must do it, before design and testing take place. A documented set of requirements gives the project team, Service Desk users, Level 2 technicians and evaluators a shared and traceable reference for the intended scope of the solution.

Functional requirements describe the capabilities the solution must provide at each stage of the incident lifecycle, from creating and classifying an incident to resolving it and capturing reusable knowledge. Non-functional requirements describe the quality attributes within which those capabilities must operate: usability, security, reliability, performance, availability and scalability. Together they set the project scope: FR-1 to FR-12 define what is in scope, and NFR-1 to NFR-6 define the expected quality of the solution.

The requirements follow the ServiceNow Incident Management lifecycle:

> **Service & Service Offering → Incident Creation → Classification → Knowledge & Agent Assist → Reassignment & Escalation → Level 2 Investigation → Emergency Change / Child Incident → Resolution & Closure → Knowledge Article → SLA, Related Records & Validation**

Status note: All requirements in this document are stated as proposed requirements. The source document does not include implementation or test evidence, so no requirement is marked as implemented.

2. Functional Requirements

The following functional requirements describe the expected behaviour of the Incident Lifecycle Automation solution. For each requirement, the table gives the expected functionality, its purpose and the part of the incident lifecycle that it supports.

FR No.	Functional Requirement (Epic)	Sub-Requirement (Story / Sub-Task) and Expected Functionality	Purpose and Lifecycle Role	Status
FR-1	**Service & Service Offering**	Create or select the required Service and Service Offering for the incident, so that classification and support context are available on the record.	**Purpose:** Identify which business service and offering is affected so the incident is handled in the right support context. **Lifecycle role:** Context stage: the selected service context is carried with the incident into classification, escalation and related records.	Proposed
FR-2	**Incident Record Creation**	Create an Incident Record containing the required incident information and the standard lifecycle fields.	**Purpose:** Provide one structured record for the issue so it can be tracked. **Lifecycle role:** Starting point: every later activity (investigation, change, resolution) is recorded against this single, traceable record.	Proposed
FR-3	**Incident Classification**	Classify each incident using Category, Subcategory, Urgency, Service and Configuration Item (CI), and save the values on the incident.	**Purpose:** Apply consistent categorisation and priority information to every incident. **Lifecycle role:** Classification supports correct prioritisation and routing, reducing delays caused by incomplete information or wrong categorisation.	Proposed
FR-4	**Knowledge Management & Agent Assist**	Search and use Knowledge Management and Agent Assist to find troubleshooting guidance that supports investigation and resolution.	**Purpose:** Speed up troubleshooting by making existing guidance available inside the incident. **Lifecycle role:** Used during first-line troubleshooting and again by Level 2, so known solutions are tried before further escalation.	Proposed
FR-5	**Reassignment & Escalation**	Reassign or escalate an unresolved incident to the appropriate support team or Level 2 support, keeping the incident context available to the receiving team.	**Purpose:** Route unresolved incidents to the right team in a controlled way. **Lifecycle role:** Moves the incident from the Service Desk to the team able to resolve it without losing context.	Proposed

FR No.	Functional Requirement (Epic)	Sub-Requirement (Story / Sub-Task) and Expected Functionality	Purpose and Lifecycle Role	Status
FR-6	**Level 2 Investigation**	Allow Level 2 technicians to investigate escalated incidents, track their work and maintain investigation context on the incident.	**Purpose:** Give Level 2 a place to carry out and document technical investigation. **Lifecycle role:** Investigation stage: records what was examined and done, so progress is visible and the incident history stays complete.	Proposed
FR-7	**Emergency Change**	Create or link an Emergency Change Request when resolution of the incident requires an urgent change.	**Purpose:** Support urgent changes that are needed to resolve an incident. **Lifecycle role:** Connects the incident to the change that resolves it, keeping the incident-to-change relationship traceable.	Proposed
FR-8	**Child Incident**	Create and relate Child Incidents for related or recurring issues while retaining the parent incident context.	**Purpose:** Preserve the relationship between a parent incident and its related issues. **Lifecycle role:** Keeps related or recurring issues connected to the parent incident rather than handled as unrelated records.	Proposed
FR-9	**Resolution & Closure**	Capture Cause, Resolution, Resolution Details and closure information before the incident is completed.	**Purpose:** Standardise what is recorded when an incident is resolved and closed. **Lifecycle role:** Exit stage: ensures every closed incident carries complete, consistent resolution documentation.	Proposed
FR-10	**Knowledge Article Creation**	Create a Knowledge Article from useful troubleshooting or resolution information so it can be reused for future incidents.	**Purpose:** Preserve useful resolutions as reusable knowledge. **Lifecycle role:** Reuse stage: turns a resolved incident into reusable guidance that feeds back into FR-4.	Proposed
FR-11	**SLA & Related Records**	Provide visibility of the SLA and of related records such as changes, child incidents and knowledge on the incident.	**Purpose:** Make service-level and related-record information visible in one place. **Lifecycle role:** Gives agents and technicians a single view of the incident's service-level status and linked work across the lifecycle.	Proposed
FR-12	**Final Validation & Testing**	Validate the incident, service, SLA, change, child incident, knowledge and related records, and perform testing/deployment validation.	**Purpose:** Verify that the lifecycle, records and relationships work together. **Lifecycle role:** Confirms that the complete lifecycle and its related records behave as specified before the solution is considered complete.	Proposed

3. Non-Functional Requirements

The non-functional requirements describe the quality attributes expected of the solution. They are stated without numerical targets because none are defined in the source document.

NFR No.	Non-Functional Requirement	Description (Expected Quality Attribute)	Basis in the ServiceNow Solution	Status
NFR-1	**Usability**	Provide a clear and consistent Incident Management workflow so that Service Desk and Level 2 users can complete their tasks with minimal confusion.	ServiceNow UI / Incident Workspace and incident forms	Proposed
NFR-2	**Security**	Use ServiceNow roles, ACLs and least-privilege access so that users can access only the incident records and related functions appropriate to their role. Specific roles and ACL rules are to be defined during implementation.	ServiceNow roles / ACLs	Proposed
NFR-3	**Reliability**	Maintain consistent incident, related-record and resolution data throughout reassignment, escalation, change and closure activities.	Incident linked to its change, child incident, knowledge and SLA records	Proposed
NFR-4	**Performance**	Incident forms, searches, related records and knowledge access should respond efficiently under normal operational load. No numerical performance target is defined in this document.	Efficient forms, indexed record searches, controlled related-record / knowledge queries	Proposed
NFR-5	**Availability**	Use ServiceNow platform capabilities to support continuous access to incident management and related records, subject to platform availability.	ServiceNow cloud platform	Proposed
NFR-6	**Scalability**	Support growth in incident volume, users, services, configuration items, knowledge articles and related records without redesigning the core lifecycle.	ServiceNow cloud architecture	Proposed

4. Conclusion

The twelve functional requirements describe a connected incident lifecycle in ServiceNow: the incident is created and classified with its service context, investigated with knowledge support, escalated to Level 2 where necessary, linked to changes and child incidents, resolved and closed with complete documentation, and converted into reusable knowledge, with SLA and related-record visibility and final validation. The six non-functional requirements define how this lifecycle is expected to perform in terms of usability, security, reliability, performance, availability and scalability. Together, they define the expected solution and form the basis for the Technology Stack, Data Flow Diagram, User Stories and Customer Journey Map that follow.

INCIDENT LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION IN SERVICENOW

Technology Stack

Architecture & Stack

Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Document Name	Technology Stack (Architecture & Stack)
Phase	2. Requirement Analysis
Date	08 September 2026
Team ID	
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

1. Technical Architecture

The solution is based on a ServiceNow-centered architecture. Users interact through the ServiceNow interface; Incident Management coordinates classification and lifecycle activities; and Service / Service Offering, CI, Knowledge, Change Management, parent/child incidents, SLA and resolution records provide the supporting capabilities. No technology outside the ServiceNow platform is assumed.

1.1 Roles of the Architecture Components

Component	Role in the Solution
Service Desk Agent	First-line user. Receives the issue, creates and classifies the incident, searches Knowledge Management and Agent Assist, creates Child Incidents where required, and reassigns or escalates the incident if it cannot be resolved.
Level 2 Technician	Receives escalated incidents, investigates and records investigation work, creates or links an Emergency Change Request when an urgent change is needed, and records the resolution and closure information.
ServiceNow User Interface	The Incident Workspace and forms through which the Service Desk Agent and Level 2 Technician enter, view and update incident and related-record information.
Incident Management	The core process that coordinates incident creation, classification, assignment, reassignment, escalation and the remaining lifecycle activities.
Service and Service Offering	Identify the service, and the offering within it, that is affected by the incident, giving the incident its support context.
Configuration Items (CI)	Identify the specific component affected by the incident, providing operational context from the CMDB.
Knowledge Management and Agent Assist	Provide searchable troubleshooting guidance during investigation and resolution.
Change Management	Holds the Emergency Change Request that is created or linked when resolving the incident requires an urgent change.
Parent and Child Incidents	Relate child incidents for related or recurring issues to the parent incident, retaining the parent context.

Component	Role in the Solution
SLA Management	Associates SLA information with the incident so that service-level status is visible and can be validated.
Resolution and Knowledge Articles	Hold the Cause, Resolution, Resolution Details and closure information, and the Knowledge Article created from a useful resolution for future reuse.

1.2 How the Components Interact

The Service Desk Agent and Level 2 Technician work through the ServiceNow User Interface, which presents the incident forms and workspace. The interface passes incident information to Incident Management, which classifies the incident and manages its lifecycle. Service / Service Offering and CI information gives the incident its operational context.

From this context the incident draws on two supporting capabilities: Knowledge Management and Agent Assist, which supply troubleshooting guidance and lead to the parent/child incident, related-record and SLA information, and Change Management, where an Emergency Change is created or linked if an urgent change is needed. Both paths converge on Resolution, Closure and Knowledge Article, where the Cause, Resolution and closure information is recorded and a Knowledge Article can be created for future reuse.

2. Architecture Diagram

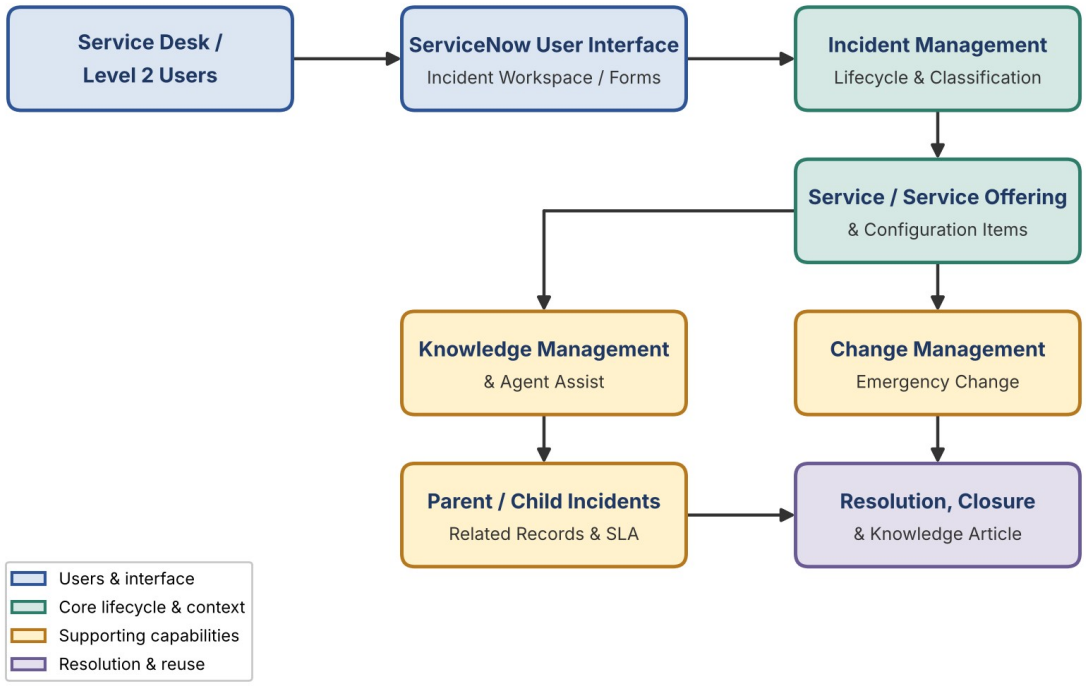


Figure 1: Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow – Technical Architecture. Arrows show the direction of the lifecycle flow.

3. Components & Technologies

Table-1: Components & Technologies

S.No	Component	Description (Responsibility)	Technology
1	**User Interface**	Provides the screens through which the Service Desk Agent and Level 2 Technician create, update, escalate, investigate and close incidents, and view related records.	ServiceNow UI / Incident Workspace
2	**Application Logic-1**	Incident creation, classification, assignment, reassignment, escalation and lifecycle processing. This is the core logic that moves the incident through its lifecycle.	ServiceNow Incident Management
3	**Application Logic-2**	Service, Service Offering and CI provide operational context for the incident, identifying what is affected.	ServiceNow Service / Service Offering / CMDB
4	**Application Logic-3**	Knowledge search and Agent Assist support troubleshooting and resolution by making existing guidance available during the incident.	ServiceNow Knowledge Management / Agent Assist
5	**Database**	The data layer that stores incidents, users, services, CIs, work notes, resolution information and related records.	ServiceNow platform database
6	**Cloud Database**	The platform-managed hosting and persistence of the application data described in entry 5. It is the cloud platform that keeps the ServiceNow data stored and available, not a separate project-defined database.	ServiceNow cloud platform
7	**File Storage**	Attachments such as supporting evidence can be associated with records and are held in ServiceNow attachment storage.	ServiceNow attachment storage
8	**External API-1**	No project-specific external API is required for the core lifecycle described.	Not applicable
9	**External API-2**	No project-specific external API is required for the core lifecycle described.	Not applicable
10	**Change / Related Records**	Emergency Change Requests and Child Incidents are created or linked to the incident to maintain traceability between the incident and its related work.	ServiceNow Change Management / Incident relationships
11	**SLA Management**	SLA information is associated with the incident for operational visibility and validation.	ServiceNow SLA / Task SLA capabilities

Note: Entries 5 and 6 describe two aspects of the same platform: the data stored by the application (database) and the ServiceNow cloud platform that hosts and manages it (cloud database). Entries 8 and 9 are retained from the original table and state that no external API is required.

4. Application Characteristics

Table-2: Application Characteristics

S.No	Characteristics	Description	Technology
1	**Open-Source Frameworks**	The project uses ServiceNow platform capabilities rather than a separate open-source application framework. ServiceNow is a commercial platform and is not described here as an open-source framework.	ServiceNow platform
2	**Security Implementations**	Role-based access and ServiceNow access controls should restrict incident and related-record operations according to user responsibility. The specific roles and ACLs are not defined in this document.	ServiceNow roles / ACLs
3	**Scalable Architecture**	Platform services separate user interaction, application capabilities and managed data, supporting growth in incidents and related records.	ServiceNow cloud architecture
4	**Availability**	The solution relies on the ServiceNow platform for hosted service availability and centralised access, subject to platform availability.	ServiceNow cloud platform
5	**Performance**	Efficient forms, indexed record searches and controlled related-record and knowledge queries should be used for operational responsiveness. No numerical target is defined.	ServiceNow platform capabilities

5. References

The original template references C4 Model, IBM Cloud Architecture, AWS Architecture and architecture-diagram guidance. These references are retained as general architecture guidance; no external technology beyond the ServiceNow platform is assumed for the project.

Note: The original document contains no hyperlinks or URLs, so none have been added, changed or removed. Components in this section are described as the proposed design; implementation status is not established by the source document.

INCIDENT LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION IN SERVICENOW

Data Flow Diagram & User Stories

Incident Information Flow and User-Focused Requirements

Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Document Name	Data Flow Diagram & User Stories
Phase	2. Requirement Analysis
Date	08 September 2026
Team ID	
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

1. Purpose

A Data Flow Diagram (DFD) shows how information moves between the people and components of a system. For this project it represents the movement of incident information: where it enters the Incident Management process, how it is enriched, and where it is passed on.

The DFD helps the team understand the interactions between users (the Service Desk Agent and Level 2 Support) and the ServiceNow components (Incident Management, Service / Service Offering / CI, Knowledge / Agent Assist, Change Management, related records and SLA, and Resolution / Knowledge Article), and confirm that no part of the lifecycle is missing.

2. Data Flow Diagram

The DFD shows how incident information enters the Incident Management process, how it is enriched with service/CI and knowledge information, and how it flows through Level 2 support, change management, related incidents, SLA tracking, resolution and knowledge creation.

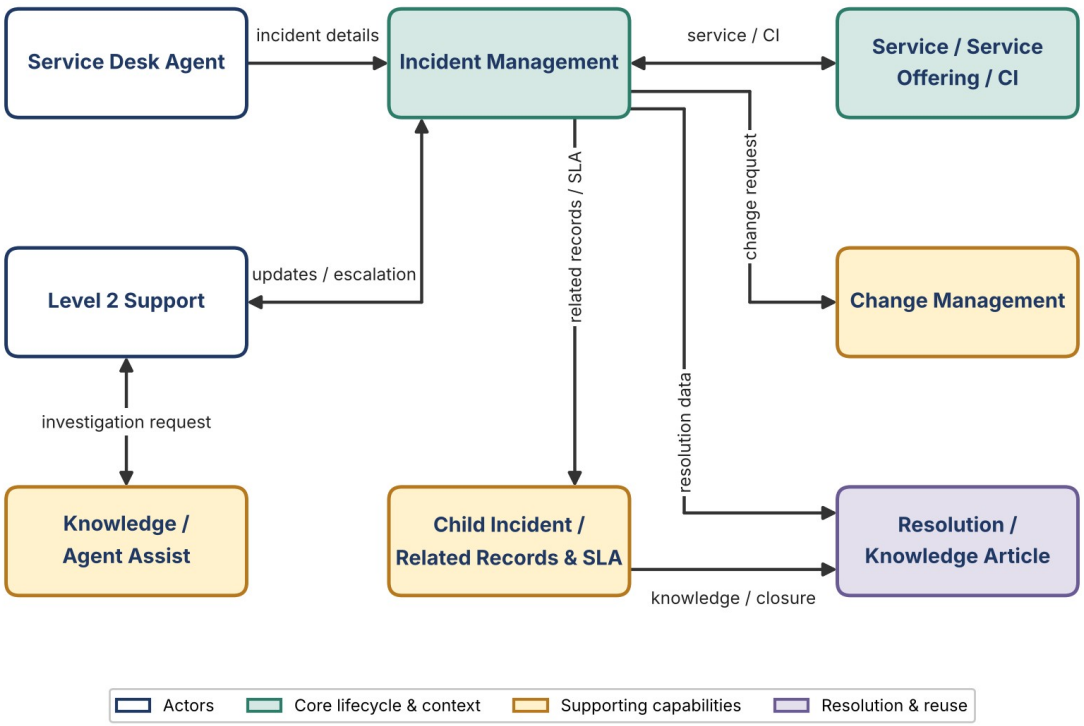


Figure 2: Data Flow Diagram – Incident Lifecycle Automation. Arrows show the direction of data flow; labels name the information exchanged.

3. High-Level Data Flow

The incident information flows through the solution in the following steps. Each step corresponds to a flow in the diagram and to the functional requirements in the Solution Requirements section.

1. **Incident creation by the Service Desk Agent.** The Service Desk Agent receives the user issue and creates an Incident Record in ServiceNow Incident Management. In the diagram this is the incident details flow from the Service Desk Agent to Incident Management (FR-2).
2. **Capturing incident details and classification.** Incident Management stores the required incident information and the classification: Category, Subcategory and Urgency (FR-2, FR-3).
3. **Associating Service, Service Offering and CI.** Service, Service Offering and Configuration Item information is exchanged between Incident Management and Service / Service Offering / CI, so the incident carries its support context (FR-1, FR-3).
4. **Using Knowledge Management and Agent Assist.** Troubleshooting guidance is searched and used during investigation (FR-4). In the diagram this appears as the investigation request between Level 2 Support and Knowledge / Agent Assist; the Service Desk Agent's own use of knowledge is described in USN-5.
5. **Reassignment and escalation to Level 2.** If the incident cannot be resolved at the Service Desk, it is reassigned or escalated to Level 2 Support. Updates and escalation information flow between Incident Management and Level 2 Support (FR-5).

6. **Investigation and related-record management.** Level 2 Support investigates and records its work on the incident (FR-6). Related records and SLA information are held and made visible through the related records / SLA flow to Child Incident / Related Records & SLA (FR-11).
7. **Emergency Change and Child Incident relationships.** Where an urgent change is required, a change request flows from Incident Management to Change Management (FR-7). Child Incidents for related or recurring issues are related to the parent incident as related records (FR-8).
8. **Resolution and closure documentation.** Resolution data flows from Incident Management to Resolution / Knowledge Article, where Cause, Resolution, Resolution Details and closure information are recorded (FR-9).
9. **Knowledge Article creation and SLA / related-record validation.** Knowledge and closure information from the related records flows to Resolution / Knowledge Article, where a Knowledge Article can be created (FR-10). The incident, service, SLA, change, child incident, knowledge and related records are then validated (FR-11, FR-12).

4. User Stories

The user stories below translate the functional requirements into user-focused tasks. Each story names the user who performs the task, the action they need, and the benefit, and is linked to its functional requirement (epic). The acceptance criteria state the outcome that can be checked to confirm the story is complete.

The original user types, priorities and sprint assignments are unchanged: USN-1 to USN-6 are planned for Sprint-1 and USN-7 to USN-12 for Sprint-2.

User Type	Functional Requirement (Epic)	User Story Number	User Story / Task	Acceptance Criteria	Priority	Release
Service Desk Agent	Service & Service Offering (FR-1)	**USN-1**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to select the appropriate Service and Service Offering when working on an incident, so that the incident carries the required service context.	The selected Service and Service Offering are saved on the incident and shown on the incident record.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk Agent	Incident Creation (FR-2)	**USN-2**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to create an Incident Record with complete incident information, so that the issue is logged and can be tracked through its lifecycle.	A new incident is created and saved with all required fields completed.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk Agent	Incident Classification (FR-3)	**USN-3**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to classify an incident using Category and Subcategory, so that it is categorised consistently for correct handling.	The selected Category and Subcategory are saved and display correctly when the incident is reopened.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk Agent	Incident Classification (FR-3)	**USN-4**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to record Urgency, Service and Configuration Item (CI), so that the urgency and the affected service and component are identified.	Urgency, Service and CI are available on the incident form and are saved on the incident.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk Agent	Knowledge Management (FR-4)	**USN-5**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to use Knowledge Management and Agent Assist to find troubleshooting guidance, so that I can investigate incidents using existing knowledge.	Relevant knowledge can be searched and used during investigation of the incident.	High	Sprint-1

User Type	Functional Requirement (Epic)	User Story Number	User Story / Task	Acceptance Criteria	Priority	Release
Service Desk Agent	Reassignment / Escalation (FR-5)	**USN-6**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to reassign or escalate an unresolved incident to Level 2 support, so that the right team can continue the work with the incident context.	The incident is routed to the appropriate Level 2 support team, and its details and history remain available to that team.	High	Sprint-1
Level 2 Technician	Level 2 Investigation (FR-6)	**USN-7**	As a Level 2 Technician, I want to investigate an escalated incident and track investigation work, so that investigation progress and findings are recorded on the incident.	Investigation updates are recorded on the incident and are visible to users with access to it.	High	Sprint-2
Level 2 Technician	Emergency Change (FR-7)	**USN-8**	As a Level 2 Technician, I want to create or link an Emergency Change Request when an urgent change is required, so that the change is traceable to the incident.	The Emergency Change Request is created or linked and appears as related to the incident.	Medium	Sprint-2
Service Desk Agent	Child Incident (FR-8)	**USN-9**	As a Service Desk Agent, I want to create Child Incidents for related or recurring issues, so that they are tracked against the parent incident.	Each Child Incident is linked to its parent incident, and the relationship is visible from the parent.	Medium	Sprint-2
Level 2 Technician	Resolution & Closure (FR-9)	**USN-10**	As a Level 2 Technician, I want to record Cause, Resolution and Resolution Details and close the incident, so that the incident is closed with complete documentation.	Cause, Resolution, Resolution Details and closure information are captured before the incident is closed.	High	Sprint-2
Service Owner / Support Stakeholder	Knowledge Article (FR-10)	**USN-11**	As a support stakeholder, I want to create a Knowledge Article from a useful incident resolution, so that the solution can be reused for future incidents.	A reusable Knowledge Article is created from the resolved incident’s information.	Medium	Sprint-2
Project Team	Validation & Testing (FR-12)	**USN-12**	As a project team member, I want to validate the incident, service, SLA, change, child incident, knowledge and related records, so that the complete lifecycle is confirmed to work correctly.	All required related records and lifecycle steps are validated successfully.	High	Sprint-2

Traceability note: FR-1 to FR-10 and FR-12 each map to at least one user story. FR-11 (SLA & Related Records) has no dedicated story in the original set; SLA and related-record visibility is covered through the validation story USN-12. The original stories have not been changed to add one.

INCIDENT LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION IN SERVICENOW

Customer Journey Map

Requirement Analysis – Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Document Name	Customer Journey Map
Phase	2. Requirement Analysis
Date	08 September 2026
Team ID	
Maximum Marks	Not specified in the original document
Primary Customer	Service Desk Agent
Supporting Customer	Level 2 Technician
Scenario	Creating, investigating, escalating, resolving and validating an incident
Journey Type	ServiceNow Incident Management lifecycle
Reference Format	Customer Journey Map example from uploaded Requirement Analysis folder

1. Purpose

A Customer Journey Map follows the people who use a process from the moment they recognise a need to the point the work is finished and reused. For Incident Management it shows the complete experience of the Service Desk Agent (primary customer) and the Level 2 Technician (supporting customer): what they do, what they use, what they are trying to achieve, how they feel and where the process makes the work harder.

Viewing the lifecycle from the user's side helps the team find gaps that a list of requirements can hide, such as lost context during escalation, and shows where each functional requirement is needed.

2. Journey Map

The journey has five stages: Entice, Enter, Engage, Exit and Reuse. They follow the incident from first recognition of the support need, through creation, classification, investigation and escalation, to resolution and the reuse of knowledge.

Customer Journey Map – Incident Lifecycle Automation (Primary customer: Service Desk Agent | Supporting customer: Level 2 Technician)

Customer Journey	ENTICE Discover / understand the support process	ENTER Create and classify the incident	ENGAGE Investigate, escalate and connect related work	EXIT Resolve, document and close	REUSE Reuse knowledge and improve future support
Steps	• Identify a user issue and the support need.	• Create an Incident Record and select Service / Service Offering. • Classify Category, Subcategory, Urgency and CI.	• Use Knowledge / Agent Assist. • Reassign or escalate. • Level 2 investigates. • Create Emergency Change or Child Incident if required.	• Record Cause, Resolution, Resolution Details and closure information.	• Create a Knowledge Article from the resolution information. • Validate the incident, SLA, change, child incident and knowledge records before deployment.
Interactions	Service Desk Agent receives the issue and determines that it needs structured Incident Management.	Agent enters incident details and classification information in ServiceNow.	Agent searches knowledge and updates the incident; Level 2 reviews history, work notes, knowledge and related records.	Level 2 / support team completes the fix and records resolution details.	Support stakeholders review the knowledge article; the team performs final validation and testing before closure.
Touchpoints	• ServiceNow Incident Management process • Service Desk communication	• Incident form • Service; Service Offering • Category; Subcategory; Urgency; CI	• Knowledge Management; Agent Assist • Assignment group; Level 2 queue • Change Request • Parent / Child Incident links; SLA	• Resolution fields • Closure information • Incident activity / history	• Knowledge Article record • Related-record views • Validation and testing results
Goals & Motivations	Help me understand how to start and capture the issue correctly.	Help me create a complete, correctly classified and traceable incident.	Help me find a solution quickly and make sure the right technical team has full context.	Help me resolve the issue and leave clear documentation for stakeholders.	Help me preserve reusable knowledge and confirm the full lifecycle closed correctly.

Customer Journey	ENTICE Discover / understand the support process	ENTER Create and classify the incident	ENGAGE Investigate, escalate and connect related work	EXIT Resolve, document and close	REUSE Reuse knowledge and improve future support
Emotions	Uncertain → ready	Focused → confident	Concerned → supported	Relieved → satisfied	Confident → accomplished
Pain Points	Unclear or inconsistent incident-handling process.	Incomplete information or incorrect classification can cause delays and wrong routing.	Knowledge may be difficult to find; manual escalation can lose context; related records may be disconnected.	Resolution documentation may be incomplete.	Useful solutions may go unused; related-record visibility is limited; validation can be inconsistent.
Opportunities	Standardise the incident lifecycle and user guidance.	Use consistent required information and classification fields.	Use Knowledge / Agent Assist; standardise escalation; connect changes and child incidents to the parent incident.	Standardise Cause, Resolution, Resolution Details and closure information.	Convert useful resolutions into Knowledge Articles and standardise validation / testing steps.

Note: The emotions and pain points shown are illustrative. No user research data accompanies this document.

3. Journey Insight

The journey should minimise incomplete information and manual routing while preserving context across knowledge, Level 2 support, emergency changes, child incidents, resolution, SLA and validation. This directly supports the project's goal of a structured, connected and traceable Incident Management lifecycle.

The map identifies challenges at each stage: incomplete incident information and incorrect classification at the Enter stage; incorrect routing, manual escalation and missing context at the Engage stage; incomplete resolution documentation at the Exit stage; and unused solutions and inconsistent validation at the Reuse stage. The table below links each challenge to the functional requirements and user stories that address it.

Challenge identified in the journey (stage)	Effect on the incident lifecycle	Addressed by
Unclear or inconsistent incident-handling process (Entice)	Agents may not capture the issue in a consistent way	FR-2, NFR-1
Incomplete incident information or incorrect classification (Enter)	Delays and wrong routing	FR-1, FR-2, FR-3 (USN-1 to USN-4)

Challenge identified in the journey (stage)	Effect on the incident lifecycle	Addressed by
Knowledge difficult to find (Engage)	Slower resolution at both Service Desk and Level 2	FR-4 (USN-5)
Manual escalation and missing context (Engage)	Level 2 does not receive the full incident context	FR-5, FR-6 (USN-6, USN-7)
Disconnected related records (Engage / Reuse)	Changes, child incidents and SLA are not visible from the incident	FR-7, FR-8, FR-11 (USN-8, USN-9, USN-12)
Incomplete resolution documentation (Exit)	Closed incidents lack cause and resolution detail	FR-9 (USN-10)
Unused solutions and inconsistent validation (Reuse)	Useful solutions are not reused; lifecycle checks vary	FR-10, FR-12 (USN-11, USN-12)

In this way the journey map, the Data Flow Diagram and the Technical Architecture all describe the same lifecycle (create and classify, use knowledge, escalate, investigate with related records, resolve and close, then reuse knowledge), and the functional requirements provide what the solution must do at each stage.